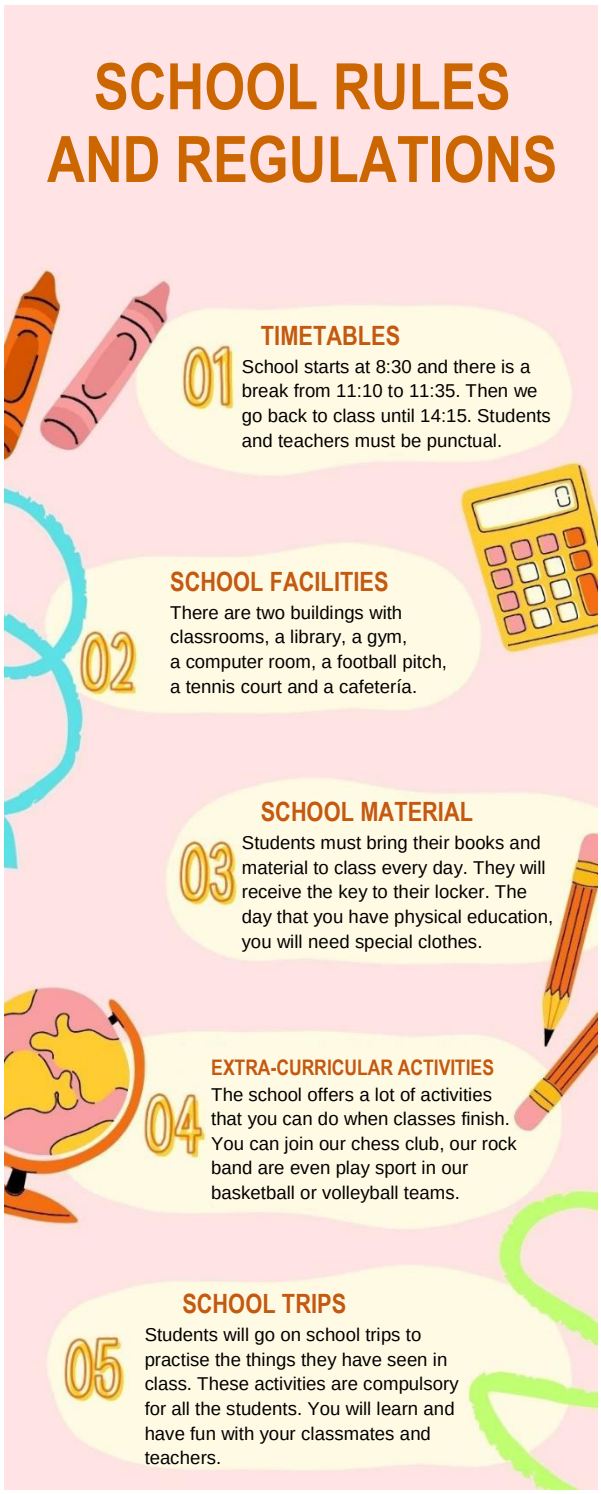
A2 - Written Mediation 2: Learning Sequence

Routines at school.

You met your friend Claire when you were in the UK on holiday. You have been sending each other e-mails for a long time. Now, she is interested in coming to Spain for a term and she wants to know about your school. Write an e-mail telling her about the timetables, activities, school trips and facilities. Include some information about the rules and regulations that she will have to follow. Give her as much information as possible, so she can have a clear idea about the school she is coming to.



Your e-mail to Claire should be between 65 to 80 words. Remember that you have to use paragraphs and follow the structure of an informal e-mail.



In written mediation, you need to understand the texts and the images provided. When you understand all the ideas, try to explain your message in your own words.

Make sure it is clear why you are talking about the topic. Refer to the context.
Write a short list with the main ideas from the text that you want to include in your final text.

Let's get ready!

1. Analyse the task

a. Read the task carefully and answer these questions. They will help you choose the register of the mediation task.

   a) Who will receive the message?

   b) Why are you going to send the message?

   c) What information does the receiver need?

b. Are the following sentences true or false?

   a) Register is the way a person writes in relation to their audience.

   b) In a mediation task I always have to use a formal register.

   c) Written language is easier to understand when it is complicated.

   d) I need to have clear ideas before I start to write.

2. Analyse the information

Read the information in the poster carefully.

   a) What information will you include in your e-mail? Pay attention to the titles.

   b) Underline the important ideas that you will use to write the e-mail.

Let's prepare the language!

1. Discuss advantages and benefits

1. Read this text where a person explains the importance of integrating when you attend a new school. Underline the gerunds.

Before changing schools, people tend to feel anxious. Changing schools can be a wonderful experience. Sometimes people consider it as a traumatic episode, but this is far from being true. After considering all the pros and cons, it is all about attitude. Having positive thoughts will make you accept the changes with an open mind and that is very important. By meeting new people, you will have the opportunity to make new friends and learn a lot from them. In the same way, you can share your experiences with them and create new bonds.

Learning new routines is easy when you know how to organise your timetable. Your classmates can be very helpful with that. Your new teachers will be happy to answer any question you have. Without asking, things will be more difficult, so don´t be afraid to ask.

If you are a dynamic person, join a club or a sports team at school. There are a lot of options and all of them will make you feel more integrated. Going on school trips is another way to learn, and have fun at the same time. Spending a day out on a school trip is a great opportunity to do something different, but don´t forget to follow the rules, it is important. Following the school rules will avoid problems.

Other Useful Language

Have a good time!
Enjoy yourself!
Make the most of …
Amuse yourself.
Have fun!

Learn new expressions to include in your vocabulary. It is a great way to express yourself in a more natural and confident manner.



2. Fill in the gaps using gerunds below.

cooking	sitting down	studying	learning	making

a) …… breakfast is the first thing I do in the morning.
b) Before…….. for an exam, I need my books and folders on my desk.
c) …… a new language is always good.
d) We spent four hours at the museum without…… down. My legs hurt!
e) I improved my diet by…….. my own meals.

2. Give reasons and examples

Complete the following sentences using vocabulary from the text.

a) The list of activities and subjects you have to do at school is your …….. .
b) A group of people who play the same sport together is a …….. .

Let's mediate!

You met your friend Claire when you were in the UK on holiday. You have been sending each other e-mails for a long time. Now, she is interested in coming to Spain for a term and she wants to know about your school. Write an e-mail telling her about the timetables, activities, school trips and facilities. Include some information about the rules and regulations that she will have to follow. Give her as much information as possible, so she can have a clear idea about the school she is coming to.

1. Content

Content

Look at the poster on page 1 and read the information there carefully again. Select the information you are going to tell your friend Claire. You can use the following questions:

- Make a list of the facilities at your school.
- Being part of a rock band at school is an example of an …… activity.

2. Language

Language

Use your own words. Simplify or paraphrase the information.

Remember to adapt your register to the task and addressee.

Vary the language you use. Look at the Other Useful Language on page 3.